Akshay Patil

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EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA **August 2026 – May 2029**
Bachelor of Science in Aerospace Engineering | Sophomore | GPA: 4.00
Current coursework: AE 1601 Intro to Aerospace Engineering, COE 2001 Statics, MSE 2001 Materials, MATH 2551 Multivariable Calculus, ME 1670 SolidWorks, CS 1371 MATLAB

School of Science and Engineering at Townview, Dallas, TX **August 2022 – May 2026**
3.97 Unweighted GPA | Rank 2 | 1600 SAT | National Merit Scholar | NASA High School Aerospace Scholar

EXPERIENCE

Salvo Dynamics | Design Engineer **August 2026 – Present**
- Startup building drone interceptor aircraft, plus an RC jet designed to break the speed of sound
- Turning optimized aerobody models into load-bearing structures in CAD, and laying out the avionics that go inside them
- Developing 3D printed test airframes and the assembly jigs the production aircraft are built on

Hardpoint Robotics | Co-Founder **June 2026 – Present**
- Startup building NDAA-compliant development UAVs for customers barred from flying foreign-sourced hardware
- Modeling a 500 mm, 4 kg max takeoff weight quadcopter in CAD with 3D printed CF-Nylon parts, sized for 12.7 min endurance with a 410 g Jetson and stereo camera payload
- Sourcing carbon fiber structures and compliant components from North American vendors, where lead times shape the design as much as the loads do

SWYFT Robotics | Engineering Design Intern **May 2025 – May 2026**
- SWYFT sells competition drivetrain and structural parts to FIRST Tech Challenge and FIRST Robotics Competition teams
- Designed sprockets, gears, and pulleys for competition loads, generating $10,000 in revenue
- Created a modular robot cart for FRC teams with a detachable programming station, designed for extrusion and fiber laser cutting

RESEARCH AND CLUBS

Hypersonics VIP, Georgia Tech | Data and Communications Team **August 2026 – Present**
- Building a sonic fatigue test facility, where acoustic loading is used to find how structures fail under sustained high-intensity sound
- Designing the sensor package that measures pressure, temperature, and airflow inside the facility
- Developing parabolic mirrors to generate a uniform sound field across the test section

Georgia Tech Experimental Rocketry | Externals Team **August 2026 – Present**
- The externals team builds the rocket's prepreg carbon fiber structure in house
- Designing a fin mounting jig that precisely locates fins after they have been wrapped in carbon fiber and their exact dimensions are no longer known, and holds fin cant to within a tenth of a degree
- Devising a way to measure each fin angle to that tolerance, with a mini carbon fiber fin can going to a third party for dimensioning to validate the jig

Yellow Jacket Space Program | Turbomachinery, Engine Development **August 2026 – Present**
- Pursuing the collegiate liquid propellant altitude record and the Karman line at 100 km
- Designing electric pumps and turbopumps so the vehicle can drop the heavy pressurant tanks
- Manufacturing the impellers, pump housings, and surrounding hardware I design

FIRST Tech Challenge Team 7172 | Captain and Lead Designer **September 2021 – May 2026**
- Lead designer on four robots; 2026 FIRST World Championship Finalist Alliance, top 8 of roughly 7,000 teams
- Designed mechanisms using linkages, counter-springing, pulley systems, and geartrains
- Used industrial arm kinematics to design and build a 6-DoF arm robot that expands from an 18 in cube to 13 ft of reach
- 24 competition wins (2021 to 2026), plus Inspire, Think, Connect, Innovate, Design, Motivate, and Control awards

SKILLS

CAD: SolidWorks, Fusion 360, Onshape, Autodesk Inventor
Manufacturing: CNC machining, 3D printing (CF-Nylon), carbon fiber, epoxy
Programming: Python (NumPy, Matplotlib, Pandas, TensorFlow), MATLAB, Java, SQL, Git
Hardware: NVIDIA Jetson, Raspberry Pi, Arduino, REV Control Hub
Certifications: FAA Part 107 Remote Pilot, Autodesk Certified User (Inventor)